Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)

Phase 01 - Brainstorming & Ideation Phase

The Brainstorming and Ideation Phase is an important stage in the development of the **Import Data using Transform Maps (Spreadsheet)** process in ServiceNow. The main purpose of this phase is to identify the business requirement, understand the existing data, and design an efficient approach for importing spreadsheet data into ServiceNow. During this phase, different ideas and possible solutions are discussed before starting the actual implementation.

The first step is to understand the requirement for importing data from a spreadsheet into ServiceNow. Organizations often maintain information in Excel or CSV files, such as employee details, incidents, assets, configuration items, users, or other business records. Manually entering these records into ServiceNow can consume significant time and may result in data-entry errors. Therefore, the idea is to create an automated or semi-automated process that allows spreadsheet data to be imported efficiently.

The next step is to analyze the source spreadsheet. The team identifies the columns available in the spreadsheet and determines how each column should correspond to fields in the ServiceNow target table. For example, a spreadsheet containing employee information may include fields such as Employee Name, Employee ID, Email, Department, and Location. These fields must be compared with the corresponding fields available in the ServiceNow table. This analysis helps identify missing fields, duplicate information, incorrect formats, and unnecessary data.

During brainstorming, different approaches for importing the data can be considered. One possible approach is manual data entry, but this is less efficient when dealing with a large number of records. Another approach is importing the spreadsheet through an Import Set and using a **Transform Map** to transfer the data from the staging table to the target ServiceNow table. The Transform Map approach provides better control over field mapping, data transformation, validation, and record creation or updating.

The team also discusses how the Transform Map should handle different types of data. Field mapping must be planned carefully so that source columns are connected to the correct target fields. If the source data contains values that do not directly match ServiceNow values, transformation logic may be required. For example, a spreadsheet may contain department names or priority values in a different format from the values used in ServiceNow. The team can identify these differences during the ideation stage and plan appropriate transformation rules.

Another important consideration is duplicate and existing data. The team should decide whether imported records should create new records or update existing records. Unique identifiers such as Employee ID, Incident Number, or Asset ID can be considered for identifying existing records. This helps prevent duplicate records and improves overall data quality.